

Phone-y videos

As if there weren't enough things to do on the mobile phone already! Along with the usual phoning, e-mail checking, Web-browsing and SMS sending, get ready to transfer and receive film-quality photo and video images along with your calls.

Sarnoff, a privately held unit of SRI International (formerly, the Stanford Research Institute), has designed a low-power, 1.2x1 inch BLINC digital camera that can enable mobile phone users to exchange high-resolution photos and video images over

their cell phones.

Japan's NTT DoCoMo, a world leader in advanced mobile phone systems, is already offering low-quality video via its popular iMode service. It plans to launch its third generation mobile systems this quarter, which promise to deliver broadcast quality video via phones.

With these initiatives in place, mobile phone users worldwide are expected to switch over to using broadcast-quality video networks, ushering a new era of mass market video-making.

Yahoo! changes its mind in hurry

Never underestimate the power of your audience. Especially if the innocence of their children is at stake. Web portal Yahoo! learnt this the hard way.

Under pressure to develop

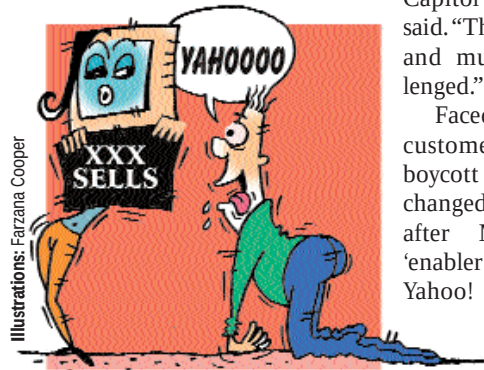
ular portal would have none of it. "The very real danger is that our children will have the very real possibility to be exposed to pornographic material," a statement from the California-based Capitol Resource Institute said. "This is not appropriate and must not go unchallenged."

Faced with a barrage of customer complaints and boycott threats, Yahoo! soon changed its tunes. Two days after Mallett took the 'enabler of commerce' stand, Yahoo! announced that it

would no longer sell adult-related products in its

Web site's shopping, auctions and classifieds areas.

Moral of the story: Don't mess with parents.



new sources of revenue, Yahoo! succumbed to offering a broad selection of adult material, including porn videos and DVDs, through its popular shopping service.

"We're hard and fast on being the largest enabler of commerce on the Web," said Jeff Mallett, Yahoo!'s president and chief executive officer. "We have chosen to offer adult-oriented content as part of that," he added.

But parents visiting the pop-

Whois?

GRUB IT

▲ What is it?

It is a real-time open source software free for downloading from www.grub.org.

▲ What does it do?

This distributed crawling client creates an infrastructure providing constant URL update status information for almost all Web pages on the Internet.

▲ What does it offer?

The distributed crawler network used with GRUB can enable Web sites, content providers and individuals to notify others when changes occur in the content. No wonder, it's your real-time search engine! The database is accessed by GRUB users via XML feed that enables them to make changes on their Web pages and update the database accordingly.

Metrics

▶ 10,00,000

people will be employed in IT services

The IT-enabled services industry will grow to

▶ \$17 billion

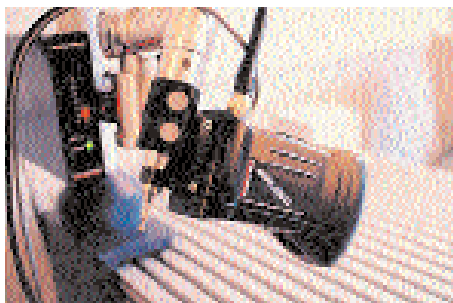
Source: Nasscom estimates for 2008

tomorrow technology

ModelMaker 3D Scanners

The ModelMaker, a handheld laser scanning system, enables users to capture 3D and colour data from complex 3D models. This is useful for animation, virtual reality and product styling applications.

It uses laser stripe triangulation technique to scan real-life images. A thin red



line of laser light scans the surface of the object, following the surface profile of the

object. Images trapped by the CCD sensors are used for simultaneous and precise measurement of multiple points.

The initial challenges lay in capturing the different positions of the object and merging together the scans collected from different angles at a good speed.